

EDWARD SNOWDEN



WHO IS SNOWDEN?

Edward Joseph Snowden is a systems analyst, former systems administrator at the CIA (Central Intelligence Agency), and former contractor for the NSA (National Security Agency). He is best **known for revealing details of various programs that make up the NSA's global surveillance system** through The Guardian and The Washington Post.



THE BEGGINING



In **May 2004**, Snowden enlisted in the U.S. Army as a Special Forces soldier, but did not complete his training after breaking both legs in a training accident. His next job was as a security guard at the Center for Advanced Language Studies at the University of Maryland; **before that, he said he had joined the CIA to work in IT security.**

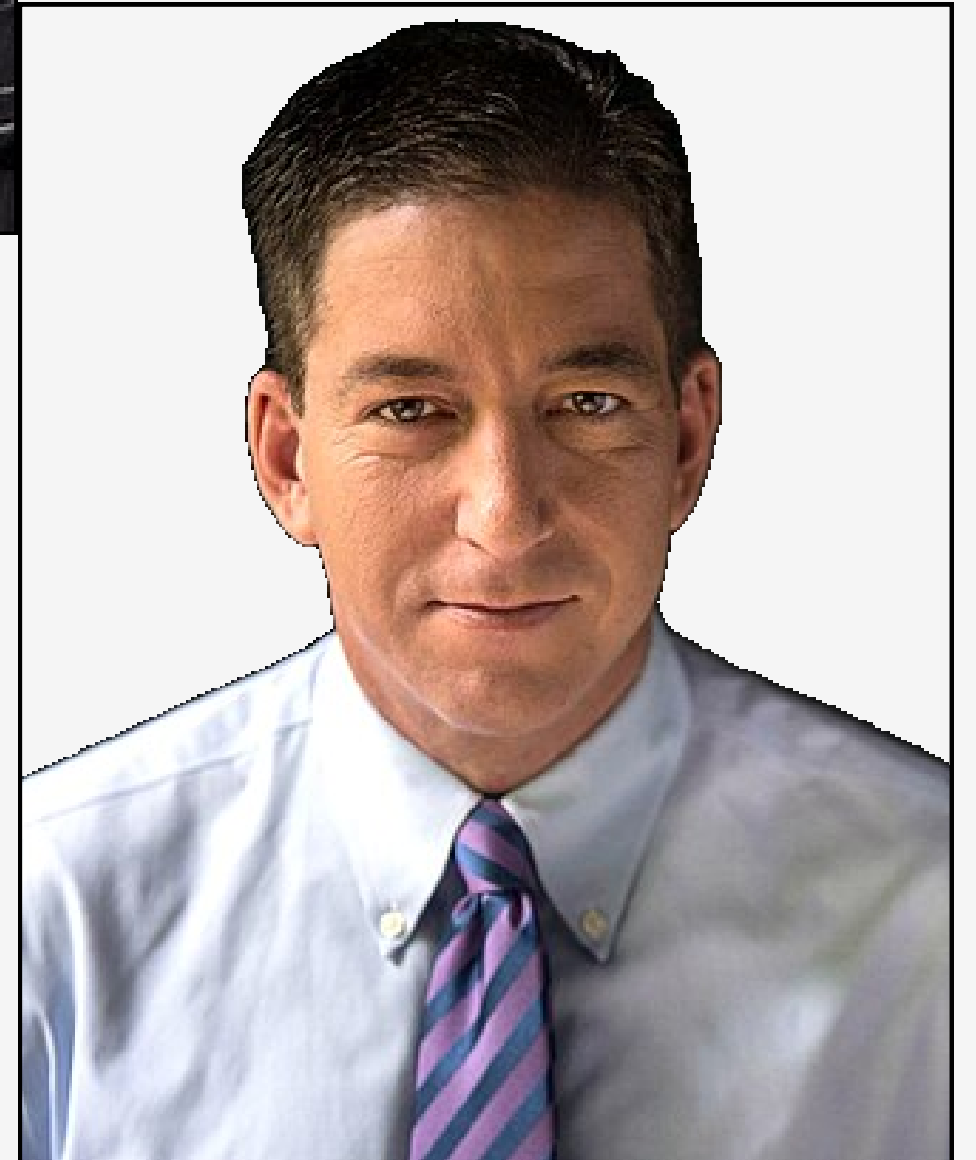
In **May 2006**, Snowden wrote on Ars Technica, a technology and IT news website, that he had no trouble finding work because he was a "computer genius." In **August, he wrote about a potential government assignment, possibly involving China**, that "just doesn't seem as 'fun' as 'some of the other places.'"

LEAVING THE U.S

On **June 23, 2013**, in **Hong Kong**, Snowden met with journalist **Glenn Greenwald** and filmmaker and journalist **Laura Poitras** and handed them the documents that corroborated his claims regarding the existence of mass surveillance programs.



In **June of that same year**, U.S. federal authorities filed formal charges against the former CIA agent for leaking classified government information that revealed details of the global surveillance program, known as **PRISM**, which monitored the telephone conversations and internet communications of U.S. citizens and citizens of other countries.





POLITICAL ASYLUM

The Russian President **Vladimir Putin offered him asylum in Russia on July 1, 2013**, but made it a condition that Edward Snowden stop disclosing U.S. secrets. **Edward Snowden had submitted asylum requests to 21 countries**

On **August 1, 2013**, Edward Snowden entered Russian territory after receiving documentation from the Russian Migration Service granting him asylum in Russia for one year.]

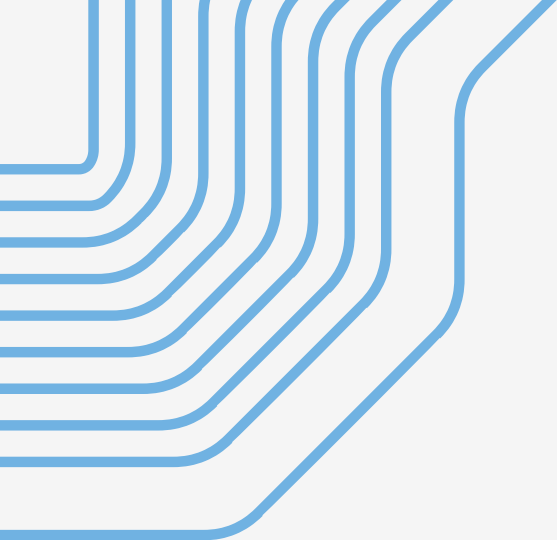
On **January 18, 2017**, Russia granted Snowden political asylum for another two years. His authorization to remain in Russian territory came three years later.



NOWADAYS

Edward Snowden currently resides in Russia, where he was granted Russian citizenship in September 2022, making him immune to extradition to the United States. He lives with his wife, Lindsay Mills, and their two children, who were born in Russia.

Although he has been sued in the U.S. for violating confidentiality agreements by publishing his book *Permanent Record* — from which the U.S. government is attempting to recover royalties—Snowden leads a relatively normal life in the country, traveling within Russia and participating in virtual events.



THE END

THANK YOU FOR WATCHING

